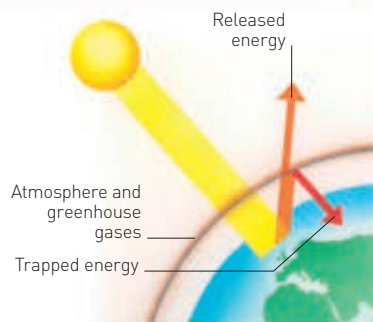


Environment in danger

Pollution, deforestation, and the burning of fossil fuels are all changing the environment and making it difficult for many species of plants and animals to survive. However, there are plenty of ways to slow down these harmful effects on the environment, from thinking carefully about what can be recycled to finding new, greener sources of energy.

GREENHOUSE EFFECT

Some gases, such as carbon dioxide, make the atmosphere behave like the glass of a greenhouse, trapping solar heat. This process, which keeps Earth at a comfortable temperature, is called the "greenhouse effect".



GLOBAL WARMING

Burning fossil fuels like coal and oil releases more greenhouse gases into the atmosphere, warming the planet.

GLOBAL WARMING

The warming up of the Earth may sound like a good thing at first, but it actually has severe consequences. Even a tiny shift of one or two degrees in temperature can change the balance of the planet and eventually lead to the loss of wildlife habitats, farmland, and even human lives.



SEA-LEVEL RISES

As the ice in polar regions melts and sea levels rise, coastal land and homes will be lost.



OCEAN BECOMES MORE ACIDIC

Sea creatures, including coral reefs, are dying as their environment changes.



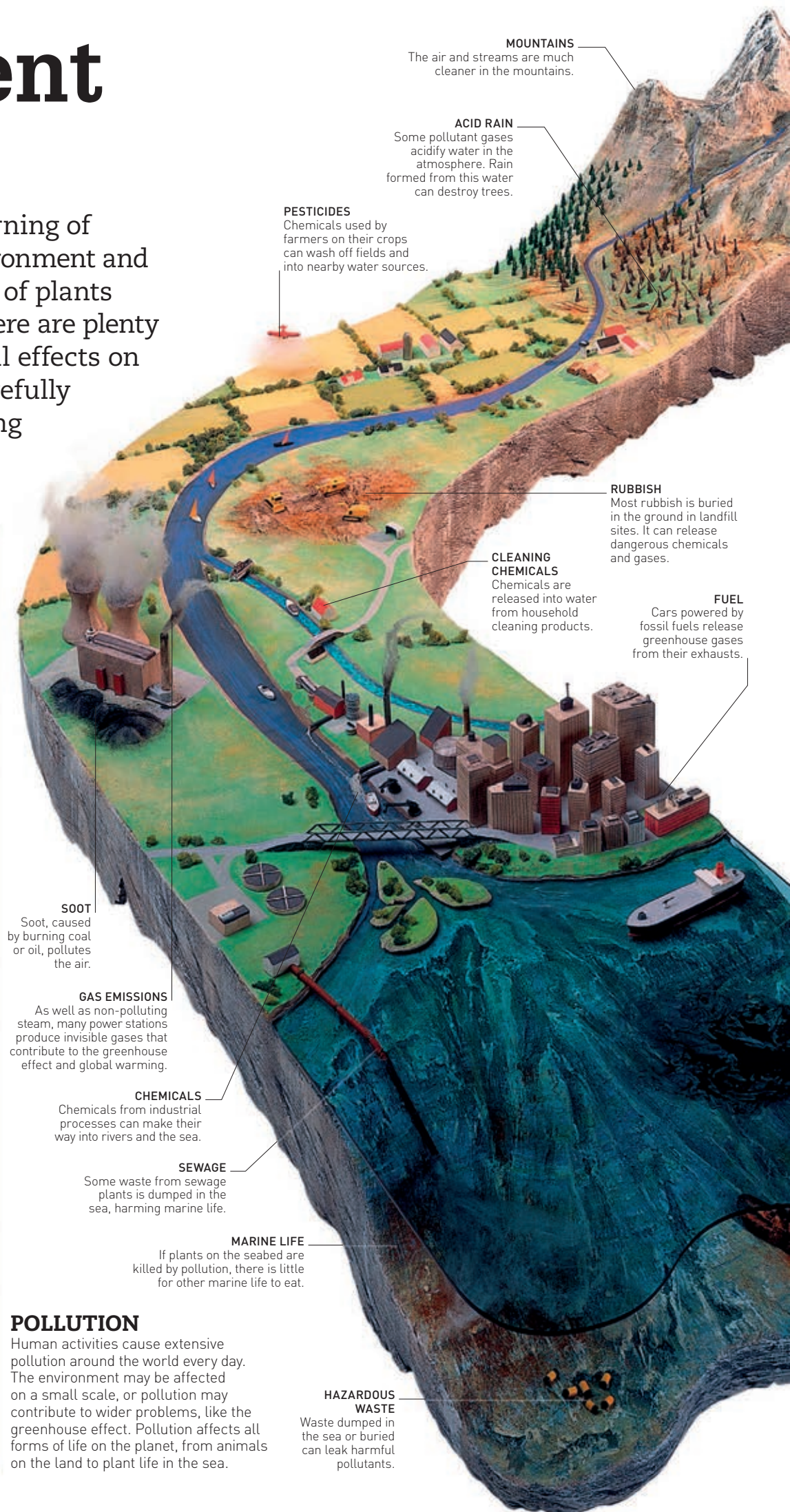
EXTREME WEATHER

Global warming leads to destructive storms, floods, and droughts.



DESERTS EXPAND

An increase in global temperature will lead to more desert areas, destroying habitats and farmland.



MOUNTAINS

The air and streams are much cleaner in the mountains.

ACID RAIN

Some pollutant gases acidify water in the atmosphere. Rain formed from this water can destroy trees.

PESTICIDES

Chemicals used by farmers on their crops can wash off fields and into nearby water sources.

RUBBISH

Most rubbish is buried in the ground in landfill sites. It can release dangerous chemicals and gases.

CLEANING CHEMICALS

Chemicals are released into water from household cleaning products.

FUEL

Cars powered by fossil fuels release greenhouse gases from their exhausts.

SOOT

Soot, caused by burning coal or oil, pollutes the air.

GAS EMISSIONS

As well as non-polluting steam, many power stations produce invisible gases that contribute to the greenhouse effect and global warming.

CHEMICALS

Chemicals from industrial processes can make their way into rivers and the sea.

SEWAGE

Some waste from sewage plants is dumped in the sea, harming marine life.

MARINE LIFE

If plants on the seabed are killed by pollution, there is little for other marine life to eat.

POLLUTION

Human activities cause extensive pollution around the world every day. The environment may be affected on a small scale, or pollution may contribute to wider problems, like the greenhouse effect. Pollution affects all forms of life on the planet, from animals on the land to plant life in the sea.

HAZARDOUS WASTE

Waste dumped in the sea or buried can leak harmful pollutants.